

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner bringing operational precision to retail logistics.*

Positioning, ten years of translating complex workflows into scalable software, now focused on reducing friction in goods flow and in-market operations.

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Dear Alexander Schmidt-Blacha and the OBI Product team,

OBI's product mission in logistics reads clearly: remove the complexity that pulls store colleagues away from customers. That is a concrete, worthwhile problem, and it is the kind of problem I have spent the last decade solving – not in retail goods flow specifically, but in equally intricate operational environments where the wrong abstraction level in a user story costs weeks of rework and where stakeholder trust, once lost, is expensive to rebuild.

At Emil Group I inherited a 17-person Scrum team that had lost sprint discipline and client confidence on an InsurTech SaaS platform. I split it into focused units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and led a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout. Client trust came back through weekly product workshops and honest communication about what was feasible when. At Rohde & Schwarz, working on the FCAS defence programme, I owned an AI data management platform end-to-end – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, and a GitOps-based rollout that reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes. Neither environment tolerated vague requirements or unvalidated priorities, and I am used to that standard.

The logistics specialisation I completed during my Diplom Wirtschaftsingenieur at TU Berlin – covering supply chain design, operations research, and transport systems – gives me a conceptual vocabulary for goods flow that I can apply immediately when mapping OBI's distribution and replenishment logic. My earlier work as Proxy Product Owner for AOK's ITSCare unit involved migrating an internal webshop to Shopware, including a complex article catalogue integration and configurable approval policies across different buyer groups. Retail-adjacent, but the mechanics of catalogue management, stock visibility, and process-driven purchasing are familiar territory.

On the methodology side, I work comfortably in Scrum and Kanban, write user stories with explicit acceptance criteria, and treat the backlog as a prioritisation instrument rather than a

wish list. KPI definition and monitoring are a normal part of my delivery cycle; at the Federal Employment Agency I owned the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform and was responsible for both feature delivery and the data quality indicators that validated those features. I am also a fluent German and English speaker, which matters when coordinating rollouts across teams and communicating progress to leadership.

I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background translates to OBI's goods flow product context in more detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
